

Land Nr. Chickerell, Weymouth

Archaeological Desk Based
Assessment

June 2022

Land Nr. Chickerell, Weymouth, Dorset

Archaeology Desk-Based Assessment

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Avalon Planning & Heritage have been commissioned to prepare an Archaeological Desk-Based Assessment and Heritage Statement covering the proposed construction of a grid scale battery storage facility on land at Chickerell, Weymouth, Dorset.

Desk-based sources of evidence indicate that there are several foci of archaeological activity of the Roman and Medieval periods lying within 1km of the site. However, an Archaeological Trench Evaluation of The Site, commissioned as part of the current application, has demonstrated that no such focus is located on or in the near vicinity of The Site. The work did record a single ditch of unknown date but produced no finds or other evidence of human activity in the near vicinity.

The undated ditch is judged to be of very low importance and though it lies within the proposed development footprint any impact is comprehensively outweighed by the substantial public benefits of the scheme. Moreover, it is considered that the information recorded during evaluation work is sufficient to characterise the feature and that there is little to be gained from further investigation. Therefore, no further work is recommended.

It is considered that the proposals meet the requirements of national planning policy with particular reference to NPPF paragraph 203, and of the West Dorset, Weymouth and Portland Local Plan – policy ENV4.

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Background

- 1.1.1 Avalon Planning & Heritage has been commissioned by 23 Energy to produce an Archaeological Desk Based Assessment covering proposed works on Land Nr. Chickerell, Weymouth, Dorset. It will form part of a Planning Application.
- 1.1.2 This report includes a description of the baseline conditions, from an examination of readily available sources on the history and archaeology of the site, identifying any known and potential archaeological receptors subject to potential impact. It proposes a suitable mitigation strategy, where deemed appropriate.

1.2 Site Location and Description

- 1.2.1 The Site occupies land centred on National Grid Reference (NGR) SY 65685 80953. It covers an area of c. 0.83 hectares of agricultural land bounded by a farm track to the north, by agricultural land to the east and west, and by a wooded area to the south. The site lies on relatively level ground at c. 38m above Ordnance Datum (OD).

1.3 Geology and Topography

- 1.3.1 The Site lies across the boundary of two geological formations as recorded by the British Geological Survey. To the north the underlying solid geology is recorded as Mudstone of the Forest Marble Formation. To the south the underlying solid geology is recorded as Limestone of the Cornbrash Formation. There is no superficial geology recorded.
- 1.3.2 Geological bore holes taken during the 1960s, in advance of the development of an electricity substation to the south of the site, recorded natural geology on the site as comprising yellow and grey clay below c. 6 inches of topsoil.
- 1.3.3 The site is approximately level at around 38m aOD. However, more broadly it occupies land on a south facing slope looking across a gently undulating landscape towards the coastline.

1.4 Overview of Proposed Development

- 1.4.1 The proposal is for the construction of a grid scale battery storage facility. This statement should be read in conjunction with the application drawings.

1.5 Limitations

- 1.5.1 This report has been prepared under instruction and solely for the use of 23 Energy, and any associated parties they elect to share this information with.
- 1.5.2 Measurements and distances in this report are approximations only and should not be used for detailed design purposes.
- 1.5.3 All work undertaken is based upon and relevant legislation, standards and guidance at the time of writing and on the professional judgment of Avalon Planning & Heritage. Avalon Planning & Heritage cannot be held responsible for implications arising from potential future changes in any of these areas.
- 1.5.4 This report relies on information obtained from third party sources. Avalon Planning & Heritage takes no responsibility for the accuracy of such information.
- 1.5.5 Where recommendations are provided these need to be approved by the Local Planning Authority and do not themselves comprise mitigation of impacts.

2. AIMS AND METHODOLOGY

2.1 Aims of the Report

- 2.1.1 Early assessment of the implications of proposed development on the heritage resource is key to informing reasonable planning decisions. Indeed, NPPF 194 requires local planning authorities to request descriptions on the significance of any heritage assets affected by a proposal, including any contribution made by their setting. This states that:

'The level of detail should be proportionate to the assets' importance and no more than is sufficient to understand the potential impact of the proposal on their significance'.

- 2.1.2 This Desk Based Assessment has the following key aims:

- To provide sufficient evidence on the heritage of the site and any potential impacts on such a resource, to inform the Local Planning Authority's decision-making process in relation to the current planning application; and
- To develop appropriate recommendations / mitigation responses, where necessary, to assist the work of the planning team.

2.2 Methodology

Study Area

- 2.2.1 The information presented in this report is based on data obtained for a study area of a radius of 1km from the centre of the proposed development site. This search area has been agreed in consultation with the Dorset Council Historic Environment Record.

Standards and Guidance Used

- 2.2.2 The assessment has been carried out in line with the Chartered Institute for Archaeologists' Standard and Guidance for Historic Environment Desk Based Assessment (January 2017).

The assessment methodology is in accordance with Historic England's Conservation Principles (2008), the Good Practice Advice in Planning Note 3: The Setting of Heritage Assets (2017) and Historic England Advice Note 12: Statements of Heritage Significance.

Selection and Assessment of Sources

- 2.2.3 In line with para 3.3.6 and Annex 1 of the Chartered Institute for Archaeologists' Standard and Guidance for Historic Environment Desk Based Assessment, this report considers appropriate sources of information and a rationale behind their use. These have been detailed in Table 1.

Table 1: Examination of Appropriate Sources

SOURCE	TYPE OF EVIDENCE	CONSULTED	COMMENT
Dorset Historic Environment Record	The primary source of information concerning the current state of archaeological and architectural knowledge in this area. Contains published and unpublished archaeological and historical sources, including any previous investigations undertaken within the study area.	28/03/2022	Accessed online. Commercial dataset ordered for a 1km search area
Consult Dorset County Council Planning Archaeologist	Early discussion with the Local Planning Authority Planning Archaeologist and / or Conservation Officer is key to understanding the significance of an area and creating a tailored approach most appropriate to assessment of a site.	28/03/2022	Steve Wallis, Dorset County Council Historic Environment Officer was contacted for comment
Site Walkover	This task allows for development of a greater understanding of any known or anticipated archaeological issues of the site, including information on areas of past truncation within the site boundary.	31/03/2022	
National Heritage List for England	Information on statutory and non-statutory designated sites, including Listed Buildings and Scheduled Monuments.	28/03/2022	
Dorset Heritage Centre Archives	Readily accessible information on the site's history from readily available historic documentary sources, maps and photographs.	29/03/2022	The archives were reviewed online.

SOURCE	TYPE OF EVIDENCE	CONSULTED	COMMENT
Archaeology Data Service	The ADS is a digital repository for heritage records that supports the long-term digital preservation of such data to support future research, learning and teaching.	01/03/2022	
Heritage Gateway	An extensive database allowing for cross-search of over 60 resources on England's local and national historic sites, buildings and archaeology, including images of listed buildings.	25/03/2022	
MAGIC	The MAGIC website provides authoritative geographic information about the natural environment from across government, including from Historic England. The information in an interactive map format covers rural, urban, coastal and marine environments.	25/03/2022	
Lidar Imagery		28/03/2022	Lidar data reviewed online. No features of note on the site or in the surrounding vicinity.
NMR Aerial Photographic Library	This database, held at Historic England's archive in Swindon, contains over 4 million aerial photographs covering the whole of England and dating from the early 20 th century to the present day. This unique collection, captures the changes in our urban and rural landscape over a period of almost 100 years.	25/03/2022	A search of Historic England's Online collection and Britain From Above produced no images of the site.
South West Archaeological Research Framework	Regional Research Frameworks have been developed in each region as part of the Regional Research Frameworks initiative promoted by English Heritage in collaboration with local authorities, in order to provide an effective yet flexible structure for decision making regarding future archaeological research.	25/03/2022	
Geotechnical Information	information principally from British Geological Survey includes information on the below ground geology of the site to better understand the potential for past activity.	25/03/2022	Borehole data available from the BGS

SOURCE	TYPE OF EVIDENCE	CONSULTED	COMMENT
Local Archaeological & Historic Societies	Using the British Association for Local History (https://www.balh.org.uk/) list of local societies, checks were made with relevant organisations where there was a specific and obvious benefit to consulting local expertise on the archaeology / history of the proposed development site.	NA	Not consulted on this occasion
Local Authority Planning Application Records	these records can provide information regarding past development on the site.	27/03/2022	

2.2.4 For reporting purposes, any relevant archaeological information gathered from the above sources has been allocated a unique Reporting Number, which can be viewed in the Cultural Heritage Features Gazetteer (Appendix 1) and on Figure 1.

3. STATUTORY AND PLANNING POLICY CONSIDERATIONS

3.1 Legislation

- 3.1.1 Current legislation, in the form of the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Areas Act 1979, provides for the legal protection of important and well-preserved archaeological sites and monuments through their addition to a list, or 'schedule' of archaeological monuments by the Secretary of State for Digital, Culture, Media and Sport. This necessitates the granting of formal Scheduled Monument Consent for any work undertaken within the designated area of a Scheduled Monument.
- 3.1.2 Likewise, structures are afforded legal protection in the form of their addition to 'lists' of buildings of special architectural or historical interest. The listing of buildings is carried out by the Department of Digital, Culture, Media and Sport under the Planning (Listed Buildings and Conservation Areas) Act, 1990. The main purpose of the legislation is to protect buildings and their surroundings from changes that would materially alter the special historic or architectural value of the building or its setting. This necessitates the granting of formal Listed Building Consent for all works undertaken to or within the designated curtilage of a Listed Building which affect special interest. This legislation also allows for the creation and protection of Conservation Areas by local planning authorities to protect areas and groupings of historical significance.
- 3.1.3 The categories of assets with some form of legal protection have been extended in recent years, and now include Registered Parks and Gardens, and Historic Battlefields. While designation as a UNESCO World Heritage Site is not a statutory designation under English planning law, such a designation is regarded as a material consideration in planning decisions, and World Heritage Sites are in practice protected from development that could affect any aspect of their significance including settings within the Site and a buffer zone around it.

3.2 National Planning Policy

- 3.2.1 The NPPF sets out government policy on the historic environment, which covers all elements, whether designated or not, that are identified as 'having a degree of significance meriting consideration in planning decisions, because of its heritage interest'.

- 3.2.2 The level of detail required in the assessment should be “proportionate to the assets’ importance and no more than is sufficient to understand the potential impact of the proposal on their significance”. It goes on to say that “where a site on which development is proposed includes or has the potential to include heritage assets with archaeological interest, local planning authorities should require developers to submit an appropriate desk-based assessment and, where necessary, a field evaluation” (NPPF 194).
- 3.2.3 A key policy within the NPPF is that “when considering the impact of a proposed development on the significance of a designated heritage asset, great weight should be given to the asset’s conservation. The more important the asset, the greater the weight should be” (NPPF paragraph 199).
- 3.2.4 Paragraph 200 states that ‘Any harm to, or loss of, the significance of a designated heritage asset (from its alteration or destruction, or from development within its setting), should require clear and convincing justification. Substantial harm to or loss of a significantly designated heritage asset should be exceptional, while substantial harm to or loss of designated heritage assets of the highest significance, should be wholly exceptional’.
- 3.2.5 Paragraph 201 explains that ‘where a proposed development will lead to substantial harm to or total loss of significance of a designated heritage asset, local planning authorities should refuse consent, unless it can be demonstrated that the substantial harm or loss is necessary to achieve substantial public benefits that outweigh that harm or loss.
- 3.2.6 In paragraph 202 it states that where a proposal involves less than substantial harm to the significance of a designated heritage asset, this harm should be weighed against the public benefits of the proposal, including securing its optimum viable use.
- 3.2.7 Paragraph 203 In weighing applications that affect directly or indirectly non designated heritage assets, a balanced judgement will be required having regard to the scale of any harm or loss and the significance of the heritage asset.

3.3 Local Planning Policy

Relevant local policy is contained within the **West Dorset, Weymouth and Portland Local Plan – 2015**. The following policies cover heritage assets including those of archaeological interest.

ENV4. HERITAGE ASSETS

- i) The impact of development on a designated or non-designated heritage asset and its setting must be thoroughly assessed against the significance of the asset. Development should conserve and where appropriate enhance the significance.
- ii) Applications affecting the significance of a heritage asset or its setting will be required to provide sufficient information to demonstrate how the proposals would positively contribute to the asset's conservation.
- iii) A thorough understanding of the significance of the asset and other appropriate evidence including conservation area character appraisals and management plans should be used to inform development proposals including potential conservation and enhancement measures.
- iv) Any harm to the significance of a designated or non-designated heritage asset must be justified. Applications will be weighed against the public benefits of the proposal; if it has been demonstrated that all reasonable efforts have been made to sustain the existing use, find new uses, or mitigate the extent of the harm to the significance of the asset, and; if the works proposed are the optimum required to secure the sustainable use of the asset.
- v) The desirability of putting heritage assets to an appropriate and viable use that is consistent with their conservation will be taken into account.
- vi) Where harm can be justified, appropriate provision will be required to capture and record features, followed by analysis and where appropriate making findings publicly available.

Chickerell Neighbourhood Plan – May 2021

The neighbourhood plan has no specific policies regarding archaeology or heritage assets. The site does lie within an area covered by the following policy:

Policy CNP10 Locally Valued Landscape north and east of Chickerell Village

The area on and below the ridgeline running east-west from Chickerell Hill (north of Courage Way) to Coldharbour (junction with Harbour Hill), as shown on Map 5 as Land of Local Landscape Importance, is a locally valued landscape that should be protected for the following qualities:

- long views to the Dorset AONB to the north;
- rural setting for Chickerell and Radipole villages and wider rural backdrop to north-west Weymouth;
- green wedge between Chickerell and Southill / Radipole; and
- part of the north-south wildlife corridor from Radipole Lake SSSI.

Opportunities to enhance the landscape features, biodiversity and informal recreational use of this area will be supported.

The impact of any development required for the successful delivery of the new road connecting the Chickerell Link Road with School Hill, should not result in significant damage to the landscape and wildlife corridors that cannot be successfully mitigated.

4. CULTURAL HERITAGE RESOURCE BASELINE

4.1 Previous Work in the Study Area

- 4.1.1 A trench evaluation of the proposed development area was undertaken as part of the current application. Full details of this work are presented in a separate report submitted as part of the application (ISCA Archaeology 2022). In summary, four trenches were positioned to target the footprint of the proposed development, of which two were blank and two each exposed a single shallow ditch. This feature was sealed below topsoil and an intermittently observed agricultural subsoil, and extended in a broadly east – west alignment across the northern part of the site (Figure 2). The back fill of this feature was devoid of artefacts or other indications of nearby settlement or other activity. The topsoil removed by machine was scanned for artefacts with none recovered.
- 4.1.2 There are eight sites within the 1km study area which have been subject to archaeological investigation using a variety of techniques. These are summarised below in order of their proximity to the application site with the nearest first:
- Littlemoor to Chickerell Pipeline – Located to the west of the site passing close to the northwest corner of the site. Monitoring of this pipeline produced residual pottery sherds of prehistoric origin from c. 200m to the west of the site.
 - Land at East Chickerell – Located 360m to the west of the site. A large parcel of land covering c. 22 hectares of pasture on the east side of Chickerell was subject to desk-based assessment, geophysical survey and Trial Trench evaluation. The results demonstrated the presence of Romano British field systems and enclosures, and recorded evidence for possible settlement in the near vicinity.
 - East Chickerell Court – Located c. 400m to the southwest of the site. A desk-based study was undertaken in 1997 in advance of the construction of an electricity substation.
 - Land at Radipole - Located c. 540m to the east of the site. Excavations and investigations in the 1970s recorded the remains of a Romano-British cemetery and deposits related to possible occupation.
 - 18 Cold Harbour – Located c. 550m to the north of the site. Investigations in 1996 recorded the remains of two inhumation burials of late Romano-British or early medieval date. Possibly part of a larger cemetery.

- Chapneys Lake – Located c. 640m to the south of the site. Archaeological assessment and trial trench evaluation recorded limited results. A single undated feature and residual prehistoric finds.
- Lower Putton Lane – Located c. 750m to the southwest of the site. Archaeological excavations at the site in 2016 recorded extensive remains of a medieval manorial complex at the site. Thought to represent the original Manorial centre of Putton.
- School Hill – Located 900m to the west of the site. A large parcel of land on the north side of Chickerell was archaeologically evaluated by trial trenches in 2016. The results recorded spreads of medieval pottery overlying Romano-British features including pits, and ditches with character akin to a farming settlement. No building remains were recorded.

4.1.3 The evidence recorded by fieldworks within 1km of the site indicate activity in the Roman period to the east, west and north of the site. Farming and funerary activity both indicate that there was a settlement or settlements of note in the near vicinity. The location of such a settlement centre has yet to be identified, however the medieval origins of the manor of Putton have been located and investigated. This has resulted in an excellent opportunity to record and publish these important remains.

4.2 Archaeology and History Background

The Prehistoric Period (c. 500,000BC – AD 43)

- 4.2.1 There are no previously recorded prehistoric finds or features within the application site, however, a recent trench evaluation (ISCA Archaeology 2022) has recorded a single undated ditch.
- 4.2.2 Within the study area, a Neolithic Hand Axe (1) was recovered in c. 1954 from c. 250m to the east of the site. To the north of the site a wide linear earthwork has been characterised as of prehistoric origin but this interpretation has not been tested by intrusive work. In addition, residual finds of prehistoric date have been recorded by investigations during the Littlemoor to Chickerell pipeline and at Chapneys Lake to the south of the site. This limited evidence of the prehistoric period indicates a level of background activity that is not uncommon and does not indicate a focus for significant activity.

The Roman Period (c. AD 43 – AD 410)

- 4.2.3 There are no confirmed Roman features within the site application boundary, however a recent trench evaluation (ISCA Archaeology 2022) has recorded a single undated ditch.
- 4.2.4 . Within the study area several episodes of archaeological work have recorded activities attributed to the Roman Period to the east, north and west of the site. These comprise a Roman period cemetery (4) on land at Radipole, a late Roman or early medieval cemetery (3) at cold harbour and field boundaries and enclosures (5) on land to the west of the site around the margins of modern Chickerell.
- 4.2.5 The evidence for the Roman period is that of a settled farming landscape with cemetery evidence potentially indicating a more substantial settlement in the near vicinity.

The Medieval Period (AD 410 – AD 1536)

- 4.2.6 There are no confirmed medieval features within the site application boundary, however a recent trench evaluation (ISCA Archaeology 2022) has recorded a single undated ditch.
- 4.2.7 In the study area the villages of Radipole to the east of the site and Chickerell to the west are both mentioned in Domesday indicating an early medieval origin. Evidence of the medieval landscape has been identified from aerial photography and LiDAR, comprising areas of surviving agricultural lynchets and strip fields (8 – 14).
- 4.2.8 During the medieval period Chickerell was comprised of three separate manors at West Chickerell, East Chickerell and Putton. Archaeological work at Putton Lane has now investigated and recorded the remains of the manorial buildings. At Radipole the medieval settlement appears to have been focused at Humpty Dumpty Field, to the east of the village (outside of the study area). This area is designated a Scheduled Monument, thought to preserve remains of a deserted medieval village.
- 4.2.9 The site appears to lie within the agricultural lands between these established medieval settlements forming part of the manorial lands of East Chickerell.
- 4.2.10 *The Post Medieval Period (AD 1537 – AD 1800)*

- 4.2.11 There are no confirmed post medieval features within the site application boundary, however a recent trench evaluation (ISCA Archaeology 2022) has recorded a single undated ditch.
- 4.2.12 Within the study area, the evidence of the post medieval period is largely of quarrying and burning of limestone in kilns (17-27), set within an agrarian landscape of enclosed fields.
- 4.2.13 Small settlements persisted at Radipole and West Chickerell and farmsteads and Putton and East Chickerell.

The Modern Period (AD 1801 – present)

- 4.2.14 The Chickerell Parish tithe map depicts the area of the site within a large pasture field lying to the north of a farmstead. There are no subdivisions of this land depicted in the area covered by The Site.
- 4.2.15 The apportionments indicate that the field was attached to this farm and is named Ewlease meaning a sheep pasture. To the south of the site is East Chickerell farm (now destroyed) and to the southeast lies Putton. At this time the former manorial centre at Putton appears to have been largely lost and the plot is described in the accompanying apportionments as house and garden with the main farmstead located to its north. At this time Putton remained separate from the village of Chickerell.



Plate 4.1: 1840s Tithe Map

4.2.16 The land occupied by the site and its immediate surroundings had altered little by the turn of the 20th century. The 1902 25-inch OS map shows the site as within open land, however, the plot appears to no longer be part of the farm to the south and is now labelled as 'Golf Course'. A foot path is also shown crossing the site. The farm to the south is shown as East Chickerell and

the settlement of Radipole to the northeast is depicted as comprising of several farms, a church, rectory and Manor House of Radipole Manor.

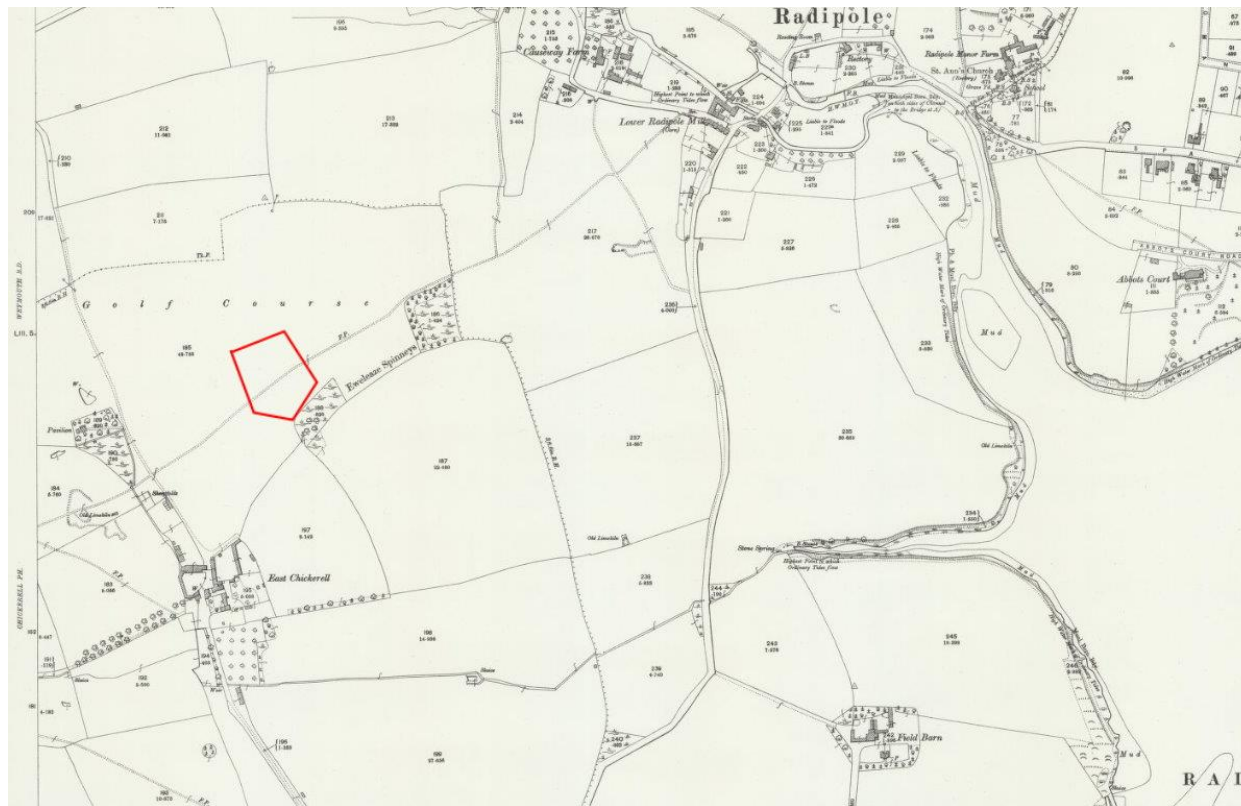


Plate 4.2: 25 Inch First Edition OS Map of 1902

4.2.17 By 1920s changes to the surrounding landscape were occurring due to outward expansion of settlement at Melcombe Regis and Weymouth around the railway station (completed in around 1854). The land around the site appears to have remained largely untouched by this growth in residential development.

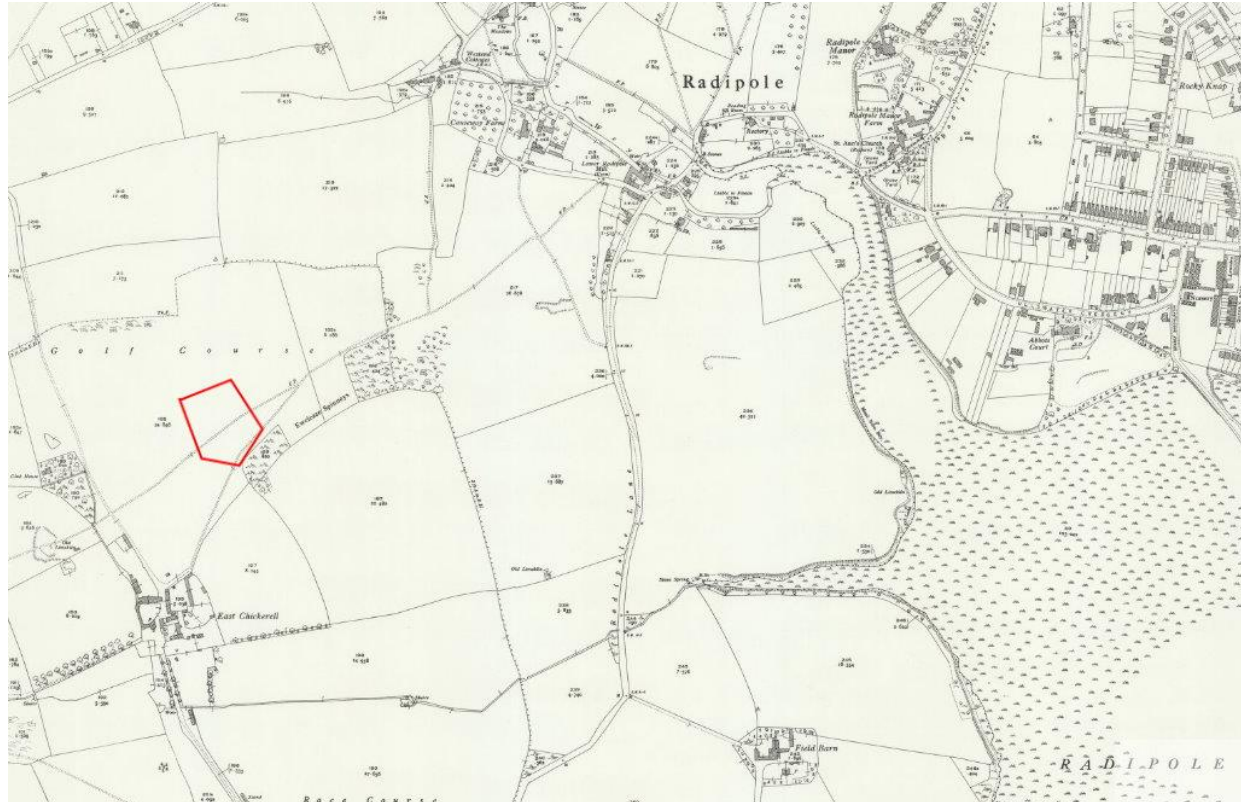


Plate 4.3: 25-inch OS map of 1927

4.2.18 Further development over the next decade resulted in residential areas laid out across the fields to either side of Radipole Lane, to the east of The Site. Once again The Site remains largely unaffected.



Plate 4.4: 25-inch OS map of 1937

- 4.2.19 Recent satellite imagery demonstrates the development of the site and immediate surrounding land for equestrian and probable rearing of livestock. The boundaries of previously large open fields have been altered and the land subdivided into paddocks, with the addition of modern agricultural structures and paraphernalia.
- 4.2.20 The farm of East Chickerell has been replaced by a large modern electricity substation and land to the west has been developed as a solar farm. Although the historic landscape has been substantially changed around the site, historic Ewlease Spinney remains as a surviving feature.



Plate 4.5: Google Earth Image 2021

5. SITE VISIT

- 5.1.1 A visit was made to the site by Alex Farnell (Avalon Planning Ltd) on 30th March 2022 with the purpose of identifying any previously unrecognised features of archaeological interest, to better understand the topography of the site and to assess the potential for any past below ground impacts.
- 5.1.2 The site lies close to the top of a south facing slope and the land to the south slopes relatively steeply into a valley. The site itself is broadly level with some shallow surface undulations. The site is bounded by modern stock fencing on all sides with historic Ewlease Spinney lying to the immediate south, paddocks or stabling to the east and west and a farm track to the north.



Photo 5.1 The Site and view to the south

- 5.1.3 The land and surrounding fields are in use for modern agricultural and equestrian use reflected in modern fenced paddocks and functional buildings. The landscape is also somewhat dominated by the electricity pylons which emanate from the substation located to the south of the site.



Photo 5.2: Equestrian land use around the site

There are surface indications that the field is in occasional use for rearing livestock in temporary housing. However, there are no signs of deeper ground disturbance that would have impacted archaeological layers.

6. DESIGNATED HERITAGE ASSETS AND POTENTIAL SETTING IMPACTS

6.1 Introduction

- 6.1.1 In accordance with the requirement at paragraph 194 of the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) this statement describes the significance of the heritage assets affected by the proposals and provides an assessment of their impacts on that significance. The assessment methodology is in accordance with Historic England's Conservation Principles (2008), the Good Practice Advice in Planning Note 3: The Setting of Heritage Assets (2017) and Historic England Advice Note 12: Statements of Heritage Significance.
- 6.1.2 There are no designated heritage assets within the site boundary, therefore there will be no direct impacts to any designated heritage resulting from the proposed development.
- 6.1.3 There are a group of designated heritage assets within the study area with settings which could be affected by development. These are discussed below in section 6.2

6.2 The Settings of Affected Heritage Assets

- 6.2.1 In assessing the potential impact on the significance of a heritage asset resulting from changes within its setting, Historic England advises a staged approach (Historic Environment Good Practice Advice in Planning Note 3: The Setting of Heritage Assets (Historic England, 2015).
- 6.2.2 Step 1 of this methodology is to identify which heritage assets and their settings are affected by the development. This assessment is undertaken with regard to a consideration of the character of the setting and its susceptibility to change from a variety of environmental factors including but not limited to noise, light spill and increased traffic. It also considered intervisibility and important views.
- 6.2.3 A site visit was made to assess the settings of a group of designated heritage assets lying within the study area. They comprised a group of Thirteen listed buildings in Radipole Village to the east of the site including:
- Grade II Listed Numbers 4 And 5 West End Cottages NHLE ref: 1147988

- Grade II Listed Numbers 3 West End Cottages NHLE ref: 1147987
- Grade II Listed Causeway House NHLE ref: 1135201
- Grade II Listed Mill Cottage NHLE ref: 1135202
- Grade II Listed Alma Cottage Pump Cottage NHLE ref: 1135200
- Grade II Listed 2 Radipole Lane NHLE ref: 1096723
- Grade II Listed Rye Cottage NHLE ref: 1096724
- Grade II Listed 18 Radipole Lane NHLE ref: 1096725
- Grade II Listed Bridge Over the River Wey NHLE ref: 1096726
- Grade II Listed Letterbox Cottage NHLE ref: 1271638
- Grade II Listed The Old Rectory House NHLE ref: 1271640
- Grade II Listed Mill to the North East of the Meadows NHLE ref: 1147986
- Grade II Listed Marvels Cottage NHLE ref: 1147984

6.2.4 These buildings are clustered in the valley of the River Wey. They all, by virtue of the valley's topography, have a relatively restricted setting which does not extend to include the application site in any way, either by direct visibility, intervisibility or by historical association.

6.2.5 No further consideration of the setting of designated heritage assets is deemed necessary.

7. ARCHAEOLOGICAL RESOURCE AND IMPACTS

7.1 Known Archaeological Resource

- 7.1.1 A recent evaluation commissioned as part of the current application recorded a single east – west aligned ditch. This feature was undated by artefacts and its sterile fill contained no indications of nearby activity during its formation. It has been interpreted as an agricultural feature possibly a drainage ditch or gully.
- 7.1.2 In the 1km Study area there are occasional finds of prehistoric origin including a neolithic hand axe. An earthwork feature to the north of the site has also been interpreted as of prehistoric character, however its origin is not firmly evidenced.
- 7.1.3 There is considerable Roman-British evidence within the study area. This comprises areas of cemetery to both the east and north of the site and dispersed agricultural boundaries and enclosures to the west of the site.
- 7.1.4 Medieval archaeology consists of areas of strip fields and lynchets identified from aerial imagery and the excavated remains of the manor of Putton. Medieval farming settlements are also known to have been located at West Chickerell, East Chickerell and Radipole. Further to the east, just beyond the study area, lies Humpty Dumpty Field, Scheduled Monument, known to be the site of a deserted medieval settlement.
- 7.1.5 Post Medieval archaeology is that of farms at East Chickerell and Putton and small villages at West Chickerell and Radipole. The land around these farming settlements was enclosed as fields and dotted with lime kilns and small-scale quarries.

7.2 Past Impacts within the Site Boundary

- 7.2.1 Map regression and a visit to the site and has not highlighted any substantial below ground impacts within the site boundary. The site is agricultural land and is likely to have been ploughed in the past.

7.3 Assessment of Archaeological Potential & Significance

- 7.3.1 There is very little solid evidence of the prehistoric period in the vicinity of the site. While prehistoric activity within the site cannot be ruled out, there is considered to be a negligible potential for significant archaeological finds and features of this period.
- 7.3.2 The existing archaeological evidence from the study area suggests that the foci of Roman activity lie to the north, east and west of the site with the site itself in the hinterland between. It should be noted however that putative farming settlements in the area, associated with known field system evidence to the west and cemetery evidence to the north and east, have not been definitively located and that the generally level, south facing topography of the site is not unsuited to settlement. It is therefore considered that there is low to moderate potential for Roman remains related to features of the agrarian landscape. Roman features and settlement if present would be of Local to Regional importance depending on their character and preservation.
- 7.3.3 Centres of medieval settlement from the Saxon period onward are better understood, being related to the Domesday settlements of Chickerell and Radipole (to the east and west of the site) and the manors of Putton and East Chickerell. The Site lies within the wider landholdings of these manorial centres and could contain features of the agrarian landscape such as former boundary features but is unlikely to contain significant remains of the period. It is considered that there is low to moderate potential for fragmentary remains of the medieval farming landscape that would be of local importance at most.
- 7.3.4 The site appears to have been part of a larger pasture field in the post medieval period and is unlikely to have been the site of any significant activity. Potential for this period is considered negligible.
- 7.3.5 There is no potential for archaeology of the modern era within the site boundary.
- 7.3.6 An undated ditch recorded by recent archaeological evaluation work at The Site appears to relate to agricultural land drainage. The feature appears to be isolated and is considered to be of very low importance. The archaeological work produced no further evidence to suggest that the site contains or lies close to a focus of more intensive activity of any period.
- 7.3.7 There is negligible potential for any archaeological remains of Regional or National Importance to be present within the site and this has been demonstrated by intrusive investigation.

7.4 Impact Assessment & Recommendations

- 7.4.1 The development comprises the installation of a grid scale battery storage facility. There is currently no detailed groundworks scheme available, however, the scheme will include a bank of up to 18 battery containers (similar in scale to shipping containers) installed on hardstanding surfaces. Below ground works would include levelling of the existing ground surface and removal of material to create hardstanding across vary approximately one fifth of the site by area.
- 7.4.2 It appears likely that the proposed groundworks will impact on the single undated feature recorded during the intrusive investigation. Given the lack of other results, it is considered that there is unlikely to be any other associated remains and therefore a negligible risk of impacts.
- 7.4.3 It is considered that there is little additional information to be gained from further investigation of the feature exposed on the site and therefore no further works associated with the development are recommended.

7.5 Summary & Conclusion

- 7.5.1 Desk-based sources of evidence indicate that there are several foci of archaeological activity of the Roman and Medieval periods lying within 1km of the site. However, intrusive investigation has demonstrated that no such focus is located on, or in the near vicinity of The Site.
- 7.5.2 Although a single undated ditch has been recorded within the application site it is judged to be of very low importance and any impact is comprehensively outweighed by the substantial public benefits of the scheme. It is considered that the information recorded during evaluation work is sufficient to characterise the feature and that there is little to be gained from further investigation. Therefore, no further work is recommended.
- 7.5.3 The proposals are considered to accord with national planning policy with particular reference to NPPF paragraph 203, and with local plan policy ENV4.

8. REFERENCES

- Chickerell Parish Tithe Map 1840
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- 25 inch OS Map, 1937, Dorset Sheet LIII.6

Documentary & Online Sources

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- Wessex Archaeology, 2010, Land at East Chickerell, Weymouth, Archaeological Desk Based Assessment

Appendices

Appendix 1 Cultural Heritage Features Gazetteer

This gazetteer incorporates relevant archaeological, heritage and historic environment assets identified during a search of sources listed in Table 1 within 500m of the site.

Abbreviations

GI* LB – Grade II* Listed Building

GII LB – Grade II Listed Building

NHLE – National Heritage List for England

Report No.	Period	Description	Status	Ref. No.
1	Neolithic	Find - Neolithic Axehead		MWX464
2	Prehistoric	A wide linear bank is visible as low earthworks on aerial photographs running roughly south-westward from Harbour Bridge. The feature may be a prehistoric field boundary or lynchet.		MDO24772
3	Roman	Two Romano-British inhumations recorded at Chickerell		MWX4838
4	Roman	Romano British inhumation cemetery, Radipole Lane, Southhill, Weymouth. (Finds and investigations between 1935 – 1977)		MDO6654 (MWX3471 MWX3473 MWX3475 MWX3476 MWX3477 MWX3478 MWX3479)
5	Roman	Romano-British field system, East Chickerell		MDO41992

Report No.	Period	Description	Status	Ref. No.
6	Medieval	Deserted settlement of Putton, Chickerell		MDO871
7	Medieval	A scatter of Medieval pottery recorded near the River Wey during work on a pipeline		MWX3550
8	Medieval	Strip Lynchets, west of Corfe Hill Farm, Weymouth		MDO6603
9		Banked field boundaries of medieval or later origin - Corfe Hill Farm		MDO24820
10	Medieval	Medieval strip field system visible as earthworks on aerial photographs		MDO6604
11	Medieval	Harbour Bridge, strip field boundaries		MDO24818
12	Medieval	Historic field boundaries at South Buckland, Weymouth		MDO6696
13	Medieval	Lynchets, Coldharbour, Chickerell		MDO24767
14	Medieval	Causeway Farm, strip lynchets		MDO24783
15	Medieval – Post Medieval	Extractive pits, Causeway Farm, Weymouth		MDO24781
16	Medieval – Post Medieval	Field boundaries and cultivation marks of medieval or post medieval origin are visible as earthworks on aerial photographs to the north of Putton Lane		MDO25713
17	Post Medieval	Lime kiln at East Chickerell, Chickerell		MDO886

Report No.	Period	Description	Status	Ref. No.
18	Post Medieval	Lime Kiln near Putton Farm, Chickerell		MDO889
19	Post Medieval	Old quarry near East Chickerell		MWX3902
20	Post Medieval	Old quarry near Radipole, Weymouth		MWX3912
21	Post Medieval	Extractive pits near South Buckland, Weymouth		MWX4692
22	Post Medieval	A quarry shown on the Ordnance Survey map of 1864, Site visible on aerial photographs.		MDO23324
23	Post Medieval	Newlands Farm, extractive pit		MDO24760
24	Post Medieval	Corfe Hill House, extractive pit		MDO24790
25	Post Medieval	Lower Putton Lane, extractive pits		MDO25712
26	Post Medieval	Old kiln on first edition Ordnance Survey map. Described as a lime kiln on more recent maps.		MDO6712
27	Post Medieval	Lime kiln near Putton, Chickerell		MDO21222
28	Modern	Smithy shown on the Ordnance Survey maps of 1864 and 1903		MDO23323
29	WWII	The probable site of a WWII bomb crater is visible as earthworks on aerial photographs		MDO24736
30	WWII	The sites of two WWII bomb craters are visible as bare earthworks on aerial photographs taken in 1942 and 1946.		MDO25708

Report No.	Period	Description	Status	Ref. No.
31	WWII	The sites of four WWII bomb craters are visible as bare earthworks on aerial photographs taken in 1942.		MDO25709
32	Undated	Southill, enclosures. visible as cropmarks on aerial photographs in the vicinity of the electricity sub-station, Putton. They appear to form parts of two large rectilinear enclosures although a natural origin is possible		MDO24759

0 250 500 m

Scale 1:12,500 @ A4



Key

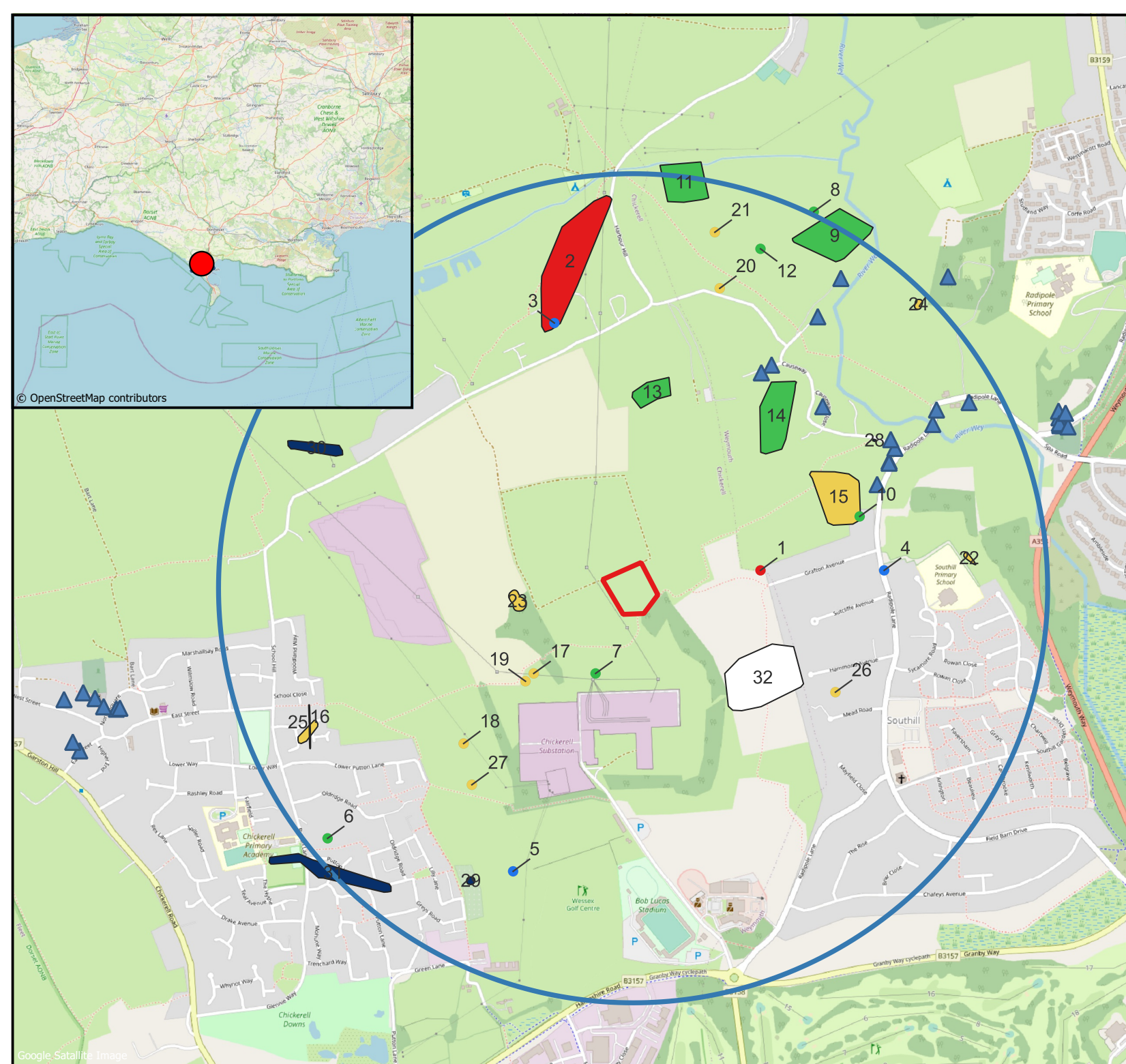
- Site Boundary
- Study Area
- ▲ GII Listed Building
- Prehistoric
- Roman
- Medieval
- Post Medieval
- Modern
- Undated

Land at Chickerell, Dorset

Project No: A2465

Date: 01/04/2022

Figure 1: Cultural Heritage Features Map



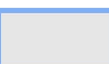
© OpenStreetMap contributors

Google Satellite Image

PROJECT TITLE
**Land at Chickerell,
Weymouth,
Dorset**

FIGURE TITLE
Site Plan

FIGURE NO.
2

-  Site Boundary
-  Trench
-  Section Line
-  Ditch
-  Excavated Slot
-  Excavated Base
-  Field Drain
-  Pipeline
-  50m Pipeline Buffer

DRAWN BY TB PROJECT NO. P04-0002
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